

To the NGI Zero Review Committee,

I am writing to express support for the Keyrack project and its application to the NGI Zero Commons Fund.

As SVP of Strategy & Business Development at Wiser Technology, I work directly with enterprise and public sector customers from multiple nations adopting sovereign cloud infrastructure. A recurring theme in these engagements is the tension between security requirements and vendor dependency. Customers, particularly in regulated industries and the public sector, need proper cryptographic key management but face an uncomfortable choice: accept dependency on US Hyperscaler KMS offerings, or build custom coordination infrastructure at significant cost.

The gap Keyrack addresses is real. Our customers consistently struggle with key rotation at scale. They deploy and manage complex key management solutions, but cannot systematically answer "what depends on this key" or safely coordinate rotation across dependent systems. This is not a theoretical concern - it has caused compliance findings at organizations we work with.

The market failure is structural. Existing commercial solutions address automation and compliance dashboards, but the coordination layer - dependency tracking and rotation orchestration - requires custom implementation for every deployment. Organizations with the expertise to build this have no incentive to open-source it. The result is that only well-resourced enterprises can achieve proper key hygiene, while smaller organizations and self-hosters are left without adequate tooling.

European sovereignty matters. I have seen increasing demand from European customers for infrastructure that does not depend on non-EU providers. Keyrack's provider-agnostic approach - working with self-hosted Vault, KMIP-compliant HSMs, or cloud KMS - enables organizations to maintain sovereignty over their cryptographic infrastructure while benefiting from proper lifecycle management.

The open source approach is correct. Key lifecycle coordination is infrastructure, not differentiation. It belongs in the commons. An AGPL-licensed solution with commercial extensions for compliance reporting is a sustainable model that serves both community and enterprise needs.

I believe Keyrack addresses a genuine gap in the European technology commons and merits NGI Zero support.

Sincerely,
Kristian Smilenov,
+359899229959